



Speed to Value: Product Thinking in the Age of AI

Patrick Robinson | SASW 2026



About me

Patrick Robinson

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AI Technical Coaching and Agentic Engineering

Agenda

01 The bottleneck moved

Why building got cheap and product work didn't

02 Think in systems

The skill that lets one person own the whole loop

03 Put it to work

Fast no's, fast yes's, and what to do today

Anybody Can Build an App Now

Software isn't the moat anymore

The moat: good data, deep relationships, iterating on
the right problem

The hard part is building something that
keeps working

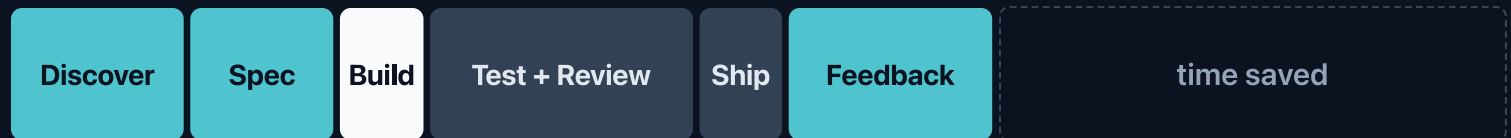


The Bottleneck Moved

Before AI



With AI



 Product work  Engineering work  Coding, ~10x faster

Skip the product work, and AI fills the gaps

Most AI slop is a workflow failure, not a model failure.

Skipped discovery

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Vague spec

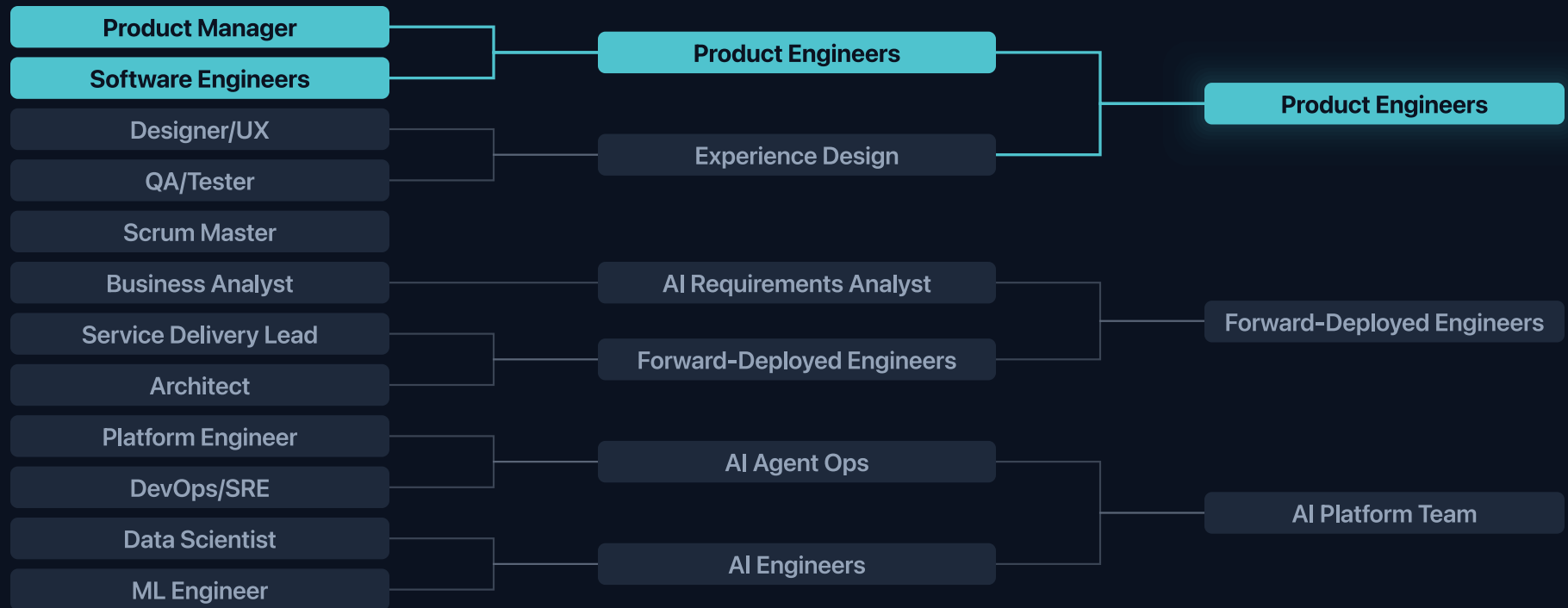
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No feedback loop

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AI slop

Where the Roles Are Heading

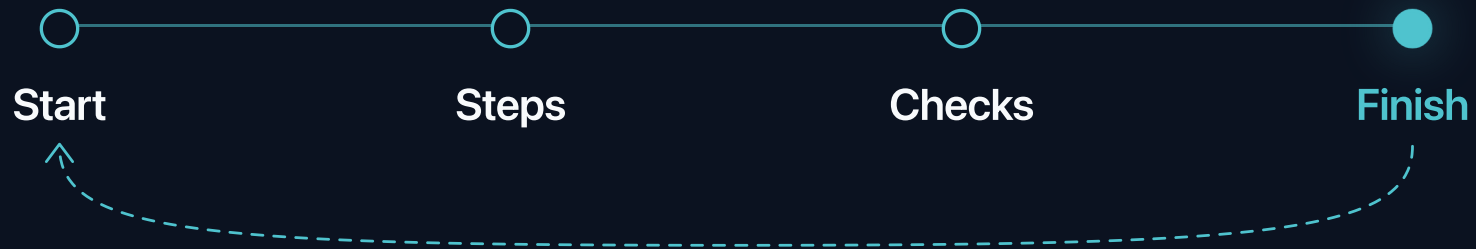


The fastest path to value has no handoff.

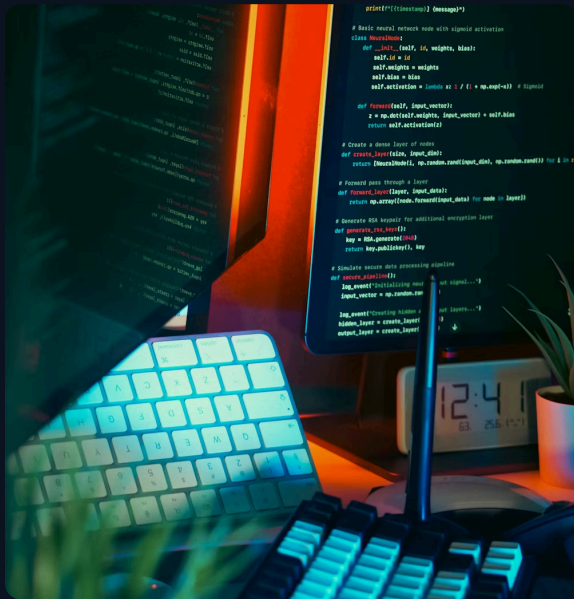
Source: Gartner, 2026

Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



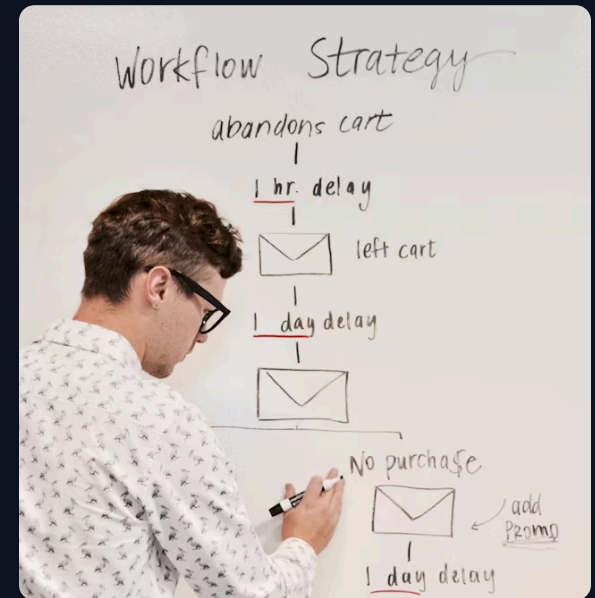
You Already Do This



The software developer



The parent with kids

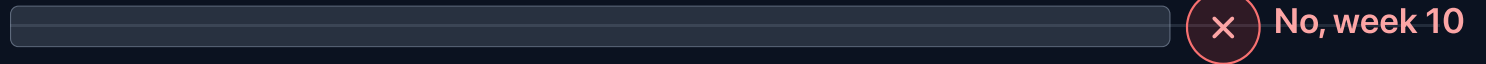


The founder at the whiteboard

You already think in systems. Now apply it to the product.

Speed to No Is Speed to Yes

One big bet



Tracer bullets



Week 0

Week 12

Every fast no buys time for the yes.

What to Do Today

If you're an engineer

Sit in on customer calls

Own the outcome, not the ticket

Write the spec before the prompt

If you're in product

Build your own prototype

Learn to read the tests

Ship one tracer bullet yourself

Building is cheap. Product thinking isn't.

- 01 Product and engineering are becoming one job.
- 02 Apply systems thinking to the product, not just the code.
- 03 A fast no buys a bigger yes.

Thank You

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